



STATUS REPORT

Madagascar: status report

Edition of 2026-08-16 · 59 systems and instruments tracked, 8 of them not held

Compiled 2026-08-14 from the Data Landscapers source base, from [outputs/reports/MDG/ledger.csv](#) (59 systems and instruments, 8 of them **Not held**). Each section opens with its ledger; specific events are covered in the monthly updates. Figures are dated because most are time-varying.

Status values. *Implemented* — in operation or in force. *Piloting* — running with a limited user group or in a controlled environment. *In development* — build or drafting under way, not yet operating. *Planned* — announced or provided for, no build or draft on record. *Enacted* — an instrument passed into law; pair with a qualifying clause for its in-force date. *Under review* — a law or policy currently being reconsidered. *Discontinued* — closed or superseded. *Not held* — the base carries no reliable statement of status; these are the gaps to fill and are listed again at the end.

Summary of position

Madagascar's digital build is one large programme with a thin layer of law around it. Biometric enrolment under PRODIGY [passed six million adults in its first phase against a two-million target](#), a [law of 28 May 2026](#) allows births to be registered en masse inside that operation, and about 10 million civil records have been digitised.

The instruments that would govern that data do not exist. The [2015 data-protection law](#) has never had its supervisory commission constituted, the [electronic-signature law](#) has no implementing decree, and the [cybercrime bill](#) adopted by the Council of Ministers on 8 July 2026 is not enacted.

Two things ran the other way. The same Council of Ministers [ordered providers to block pornographic sites with no timetable, mechanism, regulator or appeal route](#), and the dominant mobile money platform [replaced its core system in May 2026 and broke for two months](#), accounted for by the operator alone.

Infrastructure

Connectivity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
5G-Advanced trial (Yas and Huawei)	PILOTING ↗	Trial run at the operator's Andraharo campus, 23 July 2026
Airtel and Eutelsat OneWeb rural broadband	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Low-earth-orbit rural broadband partnership deepened
Antananarivo-Mahajanga fibre backbone (Orange)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	558 km backbone inaugurated after eight months' construction

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
AXIAN 4G and 5G expansion programme	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	European Investment Bank lent US\$100m under Global Gateway, US\$40m of it to Madagascar
DARE1 subsea cable extension to Madagascar	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Extension to Mahajanga and Toliara announced; work from 2026, ready for service 2028
Digital and Energy Connectivity for Inclusion project (DECIM)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Supervision aide-memoire records US\$375m, of which US\$135m for digital
Satellite connectivity for ten enclaved zones (DECIM)	PLANNED ↗	Arrangement to connect ten enclaved zones discussed with SpaceX
Starlink Direct-to-Cell service	PILOTING ↗	First Direct-to-Cell trial run at Sadabe, 11 July 2026

Data Storage

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National data centres (Tsimbazaza and Iavoloha)	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Two renewable-powered centres confirmed at the World Bank portfolio review of 24 June 2026

Cybersecurity

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
National cybersecurity strategy	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Multisectoral strategy launched at a workshop with a three-month delivery target

Terrestrial capacity grew privately: Orange inaugurated a 558 km Antananarivo-Mahajanga backbone in December 2025 as third fibre operator, and AXIAN holds US\$82m of its own money plus a US\$100m European Investment Bank loan, US\$40m of it for Madagascar, with no coverage figure published since. International capacity is contracted rather than in service: the DARE1 extension is ready for service in 2028.

The satellite layer moves faster. SpaceX ran Madagascar's first Direct-to-Cell trial on 11 July 2026, with commercial launch pending the regulator, and Airtel deepened a low-earth-orbit rural partnership with Eutelsat OneWeb. Against that, the arrangement to connect ten enclaved zones announced in March 2025 has produced no connected site on record. Yas ran a 5G-Advanced trial with Huawei on 23 July 2026; no commercial 5G service is on record.

Public connectivity money runs through one project whose supervision file is the wiki's most exact record. DECIM's envelope is US\$375m, of which US\$135m for digital, against the US\$400m the Board approved in March 2023 after a 2024 restructuring cancelled part of the financing. Its rural-connectivity tender document slipped from end-October 2025 to January 2026, the mapping having had to descend to fokontany rather than commune level; 664,000 devices had been distributed by the June 2026 review.

Hosting is being built for the identity system rather than for a market: tenders for the main data centre and the identity-card personalisation centre opened in December 2025, and the June 2026 review confirmed two renewable-powered centres with no commissioning date. A national cybersecurity strategy was launched in December 2025 with a three-month delivery target; no strategy document is held.

Digital public infrastructure

Data Exchange

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Rahaka national interoperability platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	National interoperability launched, with an online one-stop window announced

Digital Identity and CRVS

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Biometric enrolment kits and centres	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Steering committee validated the proof of concept, releasing 2,500 kits nationwide
PRODIGY biometric national identity enrolment	IMPLEMENTED ↗	First adult phase enrolled more than six million people against a two-million target

Digital Payments and Fintech

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Airtel Money and Baobab Bank integration	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Baobab Bank integrated into Airtel's mobile banking service
AXIAN Digibank and Fintech	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Fintech cluster rebranded, evolving MVola and Mixx toward a full digital bank
e-Ariary central bank digital currency	PILOTING ↗	eCurrency's DSC3 platform selected for the pilot
MVola mobile money platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Core platform replaced in May 2026
Orange Money Pro	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Business transactions application launched

Registries (population, land, address, etc.)

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Civil registry and database management contract (IN Groupe)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	EUR 8.5m contract awarded
Civil-record digitisation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	About 10 million civil records digitised across 1,695 communes with optical character recognition and AI indexing
Electoral roll reconstitution	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Full reconstitution opened at Talata Volonondry, running four months to 24 November 2026
Mass birth-registration law	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Law of 28 May 2026 allowing births to be registered en masse within the enrolment operation

Other GovTech and e-Gov

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Higher-education accreditation platform	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Presented at the ministry on 3 August 2026
Police reporting platform for violence and disappearances	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Presented at Anosy on 28 July 2026 by the minister of public security

Digitalisation of sub-national government

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Municipal or communal digital service delivery	NOT HELD	Civil registration reaches the commune and fokontany level through national programmes; no municipal digital-service system or mandate is held

National statistics

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
INSTAT microdata sharing platform	IMPLEMENTED, GATED BEHIND REGISTRATION ↗	Login and registration platform captured 9 August 2026, advertising census and survey microdata

Use of satellite data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Earth-observation or geospatial data programme	NOT HELD	Satellite connectivity partnerships are held; no earth-observation or geospatial-data programme, mandate or output is

Identity is the whole story. The first adult phase [ran April to June 2026 and passed six million people against a two-million target](#), run through [2,500 kits across 1,729 centres](#) after the [proof of concept was validated in March 2026](#), the January pilot having [enrolled about 130,000 through regime change, civil unrest and a cyclone](#). Counts are reported on different scopes and no cost figure is published.

What makes it more than a headcount is the law behind it: a [law of 28 May 2026 permits births to be registered en masse inside the enrolment operation](#), bypassing a costly judicial route, with more than 19,000 fokontany chiefs confirming undocumented identities against a de-duplicated database, on an [offline-first model aimed at the most excluded](#). Behind it, [about 10 million civil records have been digitised](#).

The register is load-bearing beyond service delivery. The electoral commission [opened a full reconstitution of the roll on 28 July 2026, running four months](#), with registration gated on presentation of a national identity card — which makes identity coverage the constraint on electoral participation and on the right to contest a result.

Interoperability is real and narrow: [Rahaka is operational at the investment board, the social-security fund, the statistics institute, the justice ministry and the tax directorate](#), on X-Road, with an online one-stop window announced. Two citizen-facing services were built outside that programme: the [police reporting platform](#), which takes online harassment, non-consensual image sharing, sextortion and AI-falsified content as reportable categories, and the [higher-education accreditation platform](#), which publishes its own queue: 546 applications as at 10 July 2026, about 250 expected at the September session.

Payments are mobile-money-led and the dominant platform is unstable. MVola [replaced its core platform in May 2026](#), and the [outages and balance-display faults users reported in May and June](#) are attributed by the operator to [that migration](#); no regulator is named, no incident report published and no compensation mentioned. The [e-Ariary pilot has a vendor and no reported live pilot](#), and [Airtel Money and Baobab Bank opened wallet-to-account transfers in July 2026](#).

Statistical microdata sits behind a gate rather than in the open: [INSTAT's microdata platform, captured 9 August 2026](#), [advertises ERISC household surveys for 2020 to 2022](#), [an ERISC enterprise survey](#) and the [RGPH 3 census](#), behind a login and registration form, with no dataset documentation, sample size, licence or reuse terms established beyond the landing page.

Governance and regulation

Legislation and regulation

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Cybercrime bill overhauling the 2014 law	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Adopted by the Council of Ministers, 8 July 2026
Dedicated social-media law	PLANNED ↗	Announced by the minister of communication, covering harassment, defamation and disinformation
Electronic signature and interoperability decree	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Draft regulatory framework validated at a ministry workshop
Order to block pornographic sites at internet service provider level	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Decision of the Council of Ministers, 8 July 2026, on public-order grounds

Strategies, plans and policies

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Plan Stratégique Numérique 2023-2028	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Standing national digital strategy
Technical Assistance Facility for the Refondation	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched at the Palais d'Etat d'Iavoloha, running 2026 to 2030 with UNDP support

Standards

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Mobile money open API conformance	IMPLEMENTED ↗	MVola documented as conforming to the GSMA Mobile Money API

Data protection

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Commission Malagasy de l'Informatique et des Libertés (CMIL)	PLANNED ↗	Provided for by loi n 2014-038 and not constituted; creation urged by an assessment mission
Data-protection law (loi n 2014-038)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	In force since 9 January 2015
United States bilateral health agreement and its data-sharing agreement	NOT HELD	—

Public debate and participation in policymaking

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Civil-society or parliamentary record on digital governance	NOT HELD	No civil-society, parliamentary or press-freedom account of Madagascar's digital governance is held

Open data

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Assemblée nationale open-data portal	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Read-only REST API and open-data pages captured 9 August 2026, publishing five parliamentary datasets under an explicit reuse licence
Open government data portal or policy	IMPLEMENTED, INSTITUTION-SPECIFIC ↗	Three of four known Malagasy open-data platforms captured 9 August 2026; no coordinated national open-data policy found
OpenData Madagascar portal (opendata.mg)	IN DEVELOPMENT, NO DATASETS OR ISSUING INSTITUTION CONFIRMED ↗	Landing page captured 9 August 2026, naming no issuing institution or linked dataset

The [data-protection law dates from 9 January 2015](#) and its supervisory commission has never been constituted, a finding an assessment mission put on the record in February 2025. The [2015 electronic-signature law has no implementing decree](#); a draft was validated at a ministry workshop in September 2025, with a framework for interoperability, and is not adopted.

The [Council of Ministers adopted a bill overhauling the 2014 law on 8 July 2026](#), defining security incidents and critical infrastructure organisations, revising electronic evidence and connection-data retention, and requiring operators to cooperate with justice. It is not enacted.

The [same Council of Ministers ordered internet service providers to block pornographic sites on public-order grounds](#) — a cabinet decision, not a law, with no timetable, technical mechanism, named regulator or appeal route. It follows a May 2026 ministerial warning and a June 2026 announcement of a dedicated social-media law covering harassment, defamation and disinformation, of which no draft is held.

Administrative reform runs through a queue rather than a decree: the [Technical Assistance Facility for the Refondation, launched on 20 July 2026](#), runs to 2030 with UNDP support and takes proposals from administrations through a digital platform.

Open data is institution-specific rather than a coordinated national policy. The [Assemblée nationale's own portal, captured 9 August 2026, serves five parliamentary datasets through a read-only, rate-limited REST API under an explicit CC-BY-compatible reuse licence](#). A second, [opendata.mg, is reachable but names no issuing institution, dataset or licence](#); the finance ministry's own portal does not resolve. No civil-society or parliamentary account of digital governance is on file at all. The texts of Madagascar's bilateral health agreements with the United States, and of the data-sharing agreements attached to them, are [withheld, and in litigation since 2 April 2026](#).

Artificial intelligence and the technology sector

AI

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
ATLAS Umoja African-language AI partnership	PLANNED ↗	AXIAN Telecom named a founding partner
Customs data and artificial-intelligence centre (CEDIA)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Launched within the customs administration in May 2025

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Madagascar-Egypt partnership on AI in public administration	PLANNED ↗	Reported by the press with no signature date given
National artificial-intelligence strategy	NOT HELD	Applied AI is in service in customs and civil-record digitisation; no national AI strategy, policy or governing instrument is held

India activities

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Indian digital cooperation with Madagascar	NOT HELD	No India-Madagascar digital cooperation agreement, line of credit or programme document is held

Applied AI is in service in two places and governed in neither. Customs [launched a data and AI centre in May 2025](#) around an intelligent targeting system and a data warehouse, and was the IMF's African pilot for AI in customs; separately, [AI indexing digitised about 10 million civil records](#). No national AI strategy or governing instrument is held.

What is announced is partnership rather than capability: AXIAN was [named a founding partner of an African-language AI initiative in July 2026](#) with no Malagasy-language model released, and a [Madagascar-Egypt partnership on AI in public administration is reported without a signature date](#). On the sector itself the wiki holds [one dated index placing Madagascar behind regional comparators](#) and no national measurement. No India-Madagascar digital cooperation instrument is held.

Inclusion and capacity

Access to services

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Fonds DECIM affordable-device facility	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Nine applications approved and in contractualisation; a US\$2.5m first call for funds made on 7 November 2025
Mobile internet tariff reduction agreement	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Operators agreed to cut prices gradually, with excise-duty relief conditioned on reinvestment in quality

Literacy

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Digital literacy programme or measurement	NOT HELD	Basic digital literacy is named inside a donor sub-component; no standalone programme document or published measurement is held

Training and skills

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
DECIM digital skills sub-component	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	US\$15m sub-component covering a virtual university, advanced skills training and the national research network
Ministry recruitment of specialist digital posts	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	259 applications received for ten established civil-service posts

Research institutions

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
UNIPOD university connectivity and AI initiative	IN DEVELOPMENT ↗	Initiative to bring high-speed internet and artificial intelligence to universities

Affordability is managed by agreement, not regulation. Operators [agreed in December 2025 to cut mobile internet prices gradually, with excise-duty relief conditioned on reinvestment in quality](#), resolving a standoff with the state. No price schedule or reduction figure has been published since, so the effect cannot be stated.

Device access and skills run through one donor facility. The [Fonds DECIM approved all nine applications from its April 2025 call](#), with two operator contracts unsigned, and the accompanying skills sub-component covers a virtual university and training for 5,700 people.

The state recruits for capability it says it lacks: the digital ministry [received 259 applications for ten established posts in artificial intelligence, data management, cybersecurity, telecommunications and digital law by 1 August 2026](#), naming its own gaps through a recruitment notice, with no appointment announced. An [initiative to bring high-speed internet and AI to universities was announced in January 2026](#) with no campus connected on record.

Finance

New investments

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Airtel Mobile Commerce guarantee (MIGA)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	US\$5,130,000 committed
Digital Governance and Identification Management System project (World Bank)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	US\$143,000,000 committed
Financial Inclusion Project (World Bank)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Committed, and restructured in October 2021
Governance digitisation project (African Development Bank)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	Committed
Telecommunications modernisation loan (China Eximbank)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	US\$54,708,617 committed on a concessional loan of RMB 337.9m
WeLight solar mini-grid and rural electrification (Norfund)	IMPLEMENTED ↗	US\$17,067,987 committed

Domestic budget appropriations and expenditure

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	STATUS ↗ source	MILESTONE
Domestic budget appropriation for digital transformation	NOT HELD	No loi de finances, annex or appropriation line for the digital ministry, the Digital Governance Unit or the identity office is held

The [Fonds DECIM affordable-device facility made a US\\$2.5m first call for funds in November 2025](#) against its nine approved applications, and the project's digital-skills sub-component carries its own budget line of US\$15m, of which US\$2.4m is earmarked for the national research network.

External finance is concentrated and old: [US\\$143,000,000 from the World Bank for the identity and digital governance project in 2020](#), which closed on 30 June 2026 with its identity component continuing, alongside a [US\\$54,708,617 Chinese telecommunications loan](#) and smaller commitments from [Norfund](#) and [MIGA](#). None has an implementation record on file, and no domestic budget line for the digital ministry, the Digital Governance Unit or the identity office is held.

Gaps to fill

SYSTEM OR INSTRUMENT	WHAT WOULD SETTLE IT	LAST PROBED
Earth-observation or geospatial data programme	A national earth-observation or geospatial-data programme document, or an agency mandate covering satellite data.	not yet probed
Municipal or communal digital service delivery	A municipal or communal digital-service platform, mandate or published local e-government plan.	not yet probed
Civil-society or parliamentary record on digital governance	A civil-society, parliamentary or press-freedom account of digital governance in Madagascar.	not yet probed
National artificial-intelligence strategy	A national AI strategy or policy document, or a ministerial decision establishing one.	2026-08-09
Indian digital cooperation with Madagascar	Any India-Madagascar digital cooperation agreement, line of credit or programme document.	not yet probed
Domestic budget appropriation for digital transformation	The loi de finances or its annexes showing appropriation lines for the digital ministry, the Digital Governance Unit or the identity office.	2026-08-09
Digital literacy programme or measurement	A digital-literacy programme document, or a published measurement of digital literacy.	not yet probed
United States bilateral health agreement and its data-sharing agreement	The memorandum of understanding and the related data-sharing agreement themselves, a signature date, or a Malagasy government statement naming the instrument. The text is withheld rather than unpublished, and is in litigation in the United States District Court for the District of Columbia	not yet probed

Eight rows are unheld. Of the three probed on 9 August 2026, the AI gap held: no dedicated AI law, strategy or regulator was found. The domestic-budget gap did not: the 2026 finance law sits on the ministry's server, unfetched, and remains on the acquisition list. The open-data gap has since been settled: captures of the Assemblée nationale's portal, INSTAT's microdata platform and opendata.mg moved *Open government data portal or policy* from *Not held* to *Implemented, institution-specific* — no coordinated national policy is held, but institution-level resources now are.

ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

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